MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 2/18/2026

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
January 21, 2026

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

District 6 Jack Kleinhardt

OTHERS PRESENT

Administrator Lori Phelps, Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger, Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the agenda, **Motion carried.**

ELECTION OF VICE-CHAIRMAN

Chairman Gilmore called for nominations of the Board of Commissioners Vice-Chairman three times. Commissioner Housler nominated Commissioner Fancon, Commissioner Majewski seconded the nomination. Hearing no other nominations Chairman Gilmore closed nominations. Commissioner Fancon was re-elected unanimously, **Motion carried**.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of December 17, 2025, **Motion carried**.

It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the Closed Session Minutes of December 17, 2025, **Motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

Steven Sentz introduced himself to the Board of Commissioners and announced his candidacy for Clare County Sheriff. He briefly described his military background and various roles throughout Clare County.

A private citizen asked for support for the Big "R" & Smokin' Joe's Comfort House. The Comfort House is an organization with the vision to provide hospice care in Clare County. He asked for the Board of Commissioners and those in attendance to help raise awareness for the upcoming fundraisers at Jay's Sporting Goods and the Harrison Moose Lodge.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Letter from the City of Harrison – No discussion
2. MMR Stats – No discussion
3. Resolution regarding Data Center Development from Ingham County - No discussion
4. Letters regarding audit – No discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps informed the Commissioners that there have been no major legislative changes at the State or Federal levels since the December 17th meeting. A significant amount of time has been dedicated to the process of the Annual County Audit and it is scheduled to be completed soon. The County has received five bids as part of the Part 115 Materials Management Planning requirements. A contractor will be selected by mid-February.

Administrator Phelps stated that she met with the Department heads to distribute updated approved policies and to discuss the Fiscal Year (FY) 2027 budget process. She has been working with Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger to implement the new chart of accounts. Several grant opportunities are her current focus including ones for homeowner rehabilitation and preservation and protection of county records. Lastly, Administrator Phelps reported that at this point in the fiscal year the county budget should be 29.17% expended yet it is at 25.61%, an indication that the county is on target and managing expenditures appropriately.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

None

JUSTICE

None

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

1. Veterans
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to increase the burial funds for Veterans from $600.00 per Veteran to $1,200.00 per Veteran, after discussion roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion carried.

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Transit/MDOT Resolutions
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Resolution of Intent #26-01 to apply for financial assistance for FY 2026-27 for Clare County public transportations program, Contract Resolution #26-02 for FY 2026-27 which allows Katie MacInnes, Clare County Transit Director, to execute contracts with MDOT, Resolution authorizing adoption and ratification of Contract Clauses Certification #26-03 which governs how any transit project requirements apply and such clauses apply to all Federally funded contracts for FY 2026-27 and Resolution #26-04 Authorizing Adoption and Ratification of Public Act 51 to maintain an Accessibility Plan with MDOT addressing accessibility for all residents, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Majewski, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion carried.

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT - continued

2. Material Management Planning
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to accept and sign the Materials Management Planning Program Grant Agreement between the Michigan Department of Environment, Great Lakes, and Energy and Clare County for FY2026 in the amount of $80,000.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore and Gross
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of December 22, 2025 in the amount of $73,722.80 and the meeting minutes of January 5, 2026 in the amount of $15,906.99, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Fancon, Gross, Haskell, Majewski, Housler, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore and Hoefling
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion carried.

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the expenditures for the month of December 2025, in the amount of $1,853,420.42 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,040,016.06, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Fancon, Housler, Gilmore, Gross, Hoefling and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Kleinhardt
   Motion carried.

3. Budget Adjustments
   None

4. November Board Meeting
   It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to change the board meeting in November from November 11 to Thursday, November 12, **Motion carried**.

5. Grant Application
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Gross to allow the Administrator to apply for a preservation grant for historical county records, **Motion carried**.

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

None

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners. She announced that a one-stop shop rabies clinic will be held at the Clare County Animal Shelter on February 21, 2026 from 9:00 a.m. until 1:00 p.m. Vaccinations and dog licenses will be available for purchase.

Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger also reported that her office, in partnership with the Register of Deeds Office, can now electronically certify that property taxes have been paid prior to a deed being recorded. Lastly, four different types of notices were recently sent out in an effort to help residents in danger of foreclosure.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman George Gilmore has attended his meetings. He reported that both of his townships are in the midst of negotiations with the Clare County Road Commission.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Rick Fancon had no report.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Housler has attended her meetings. She announced that Redding Township is seeking a Supervisor and the board meetings have changed from the third Wednesday to the third Monday of every month.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis reported that the Airport lights are almost complete. Administrator Phelps was able to get the Michigan Department of Transportation (MDOT) to claim a defective radio controller as part of the current grant. He also shared that there is a tentative Easter Egg Drop scheduled for April 11, 2026 at the Clare County Airport.

Commissioner Hoefling has attended his meetings and gave a report on each of the townships and committees he represents. Franklin Township had a short meeting. Hamilton Township continues to work on the park which is scheduled to be completed in May. Lastly, he reported that Winterfield Township is seeking names for an assessor.

Commissioner Haskell had no report.

Commissioner Gross had no report.

Commissioner Majewski had no report.

PUBLIC COMMENT

Dewayne Rogers, Manager of the Clare County Road Commission, announced that on February 13, 2026 from 10:00 a.m. until 12:00 p.m. the Road Commission Educational Workshop will take place at the Career and Technical Education (CTE) Building.

A Clare County veteran thanked the Board of Commissioners for increasing the burial funds for Veterans. He also expressed concern regarding the one-sided printing for the Lake level documents that were distributed at a recent meeting.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

ADJOURNMENT

It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to adjourn, **motion carried.**

Meeting adjourned at 9:37 a.m.

Isha Walter, Deputy Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners